

ViSPACE User Manual

Virchow-based Spatial Characterization and feature Extraction

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Chapter 1

Installation

This chapter describes how to install ViSPACE, authenticate with Hugging Face, verify the software environment, and prepare the pipeline for whole-slide image analysis.

1.1 Conda Installation

ViSPACE is designed for Python 3.11. Miniforge or another Conda distribution configured to use `conda-forge` is recommended.

Option A — install from source *(recommended)

```
# Create a new environment
conda create -n vispace python=3.11 -y

# Activate it
conda activate vispace

# Clone the repository
git clone https://github.com/himangi2003/ViSpace.git
cd ViSpace

# Install the matching PyTorch build
pip install torch==2.5.1+cu121 torchvision==0.20.1+cu121 \
    --extra-index-url https://download.pytorch.org/whl/cu121

# Install the package and its dependencies
pip install .
```

Option B — Conda environment

```
git clone https://github.com/himangi2003/ViSPACE.git
cd ViSPACE

conda env create -f environment.yml
conda activate vispace
pip install .
```

The environment installs `mussel-pathology[torch-gpu]==1.4.4`; a separate Mussel repository checkout and `MUSSEL_DIR` setting are not required.

1.2 Google Colab

Google Colab does not use the local Conda environment. Install the pip-only requirements instead:

```
pip install -q -r requirements/colab.txt
pip install -q .
```

Colab already provides a notebook runtime. Review the installed PyTorch and CUDA versions before replacing Colab's preinstalled PyTorch build.

1.3 Hugging Face Authentication

ViSPACE uses the gated Virchow2 model. Authentication is required when `VIRCHOW2_PATH=None`; it is not required when local Virchow2 weights are provided.

1.3.1 Account, token, and model access

1. Create and verify an account at <https://huggingface.co>.
2. Create a read token under **Settings** → **Access Tokens**.
3. Request access at <https://huggingface.co/paige-ai/Virchow2>.
4. Never commit the token to Git or publish it in a notebook.

1.3.2 Command-line login

```
huggingface-cli login
huggingface-cli whoami
```

1.3.3 Notebook login

```
import os
from huggingface_hub import whoami

HF_ACCESS_TOKEN = "hf_your_token_here"
user = whoami(token=HF_ACCESS_TOKEN)
print(f"Authenticated as: {user['name']}")
os.environ["HF_TOKEN"] = HF_ACCESS_TOKEN
```

Clear notebook outputs and replace the token with a placeholder before sharing.

1.4 Environment Check

Run the pre-flight check before a long analysis:

```
python environment_check.py --from-json run_config.json
```

The checker validates Python, required packages, the Mussel package version, PyTorch and CUDA availability, Hugging Face access, input paths, the checkpoint, and output-directory permissions.

Chapter 2

Configuration

All ViSPACE parameters are defined in a single configuration file, `config.py`. The configuration is implemented through the `PipelineConfig` dataclass and is shared by every stage of the pipeline, ensuring that all components operate using a consistent set of parameters. This design centralises the configuration of the complete workflow, from whole-slide image tessellation to spatial feature extraction, while avoiding duplicated command-line arguments.

2.1 Required Parameters

All settings are defined by the `PipelineConfig` dataclass in `config.py`. Table 2.1 is the single authoritative configuration reference for the pipeline. Parameters marked **Fixed** should remain unchanged for the released ViSPACE model. Parameters marked **Adjustable** may be tuned for hardware or dataset characteristics. Parameters marked **Optional** affect optional outputs or advanced filtering.

2.2 Tessellation Parameters

The first stage of the ViSPACE pipeline performs tessellation of the whole-slide image using the Mussel framework. Tissue regions are identified before the slide is divided into fixed-size image patches, which form the input to the segmentation model. For routine analyses, the default tessellation parameters are recommended. Users may adjust `WORKERS`, `SEGMENT_THRESH`, and `THUMBNAIL_SIZE` according to their computational resources or image characteristics. However, `PATCH_SIZE` and `MPP` should remain fixed at **224 pixels** and **0.25 $\mu\text{m}/\text{pixel}$** , respectively, to maintain compatibility with the pretrained ViSPACE segmentation model and ensure consistent spatial measurements throughout the pipeline.

2.3 Model and Inference Parameters

The parameters in this section control loading of the pretrained ViSPACE segmentation model and the execution of inference. These settings determine how the model is initialised and how image patches are processed during segmentation. The default model parameters are suitable for most analyses. Users with limited GPU memory may reduce `BATCH_SIZE` to avoid out-of-memory errors, while systems without a compatible NVIDIA GPU may set `DEVICE` to `cpu`. If `VIRCHOW2_PATH` is left as `None`, the Virchow2 encoder weights are downloaded automatically from the Hugging Face Hub after successful authentication.

2.4 Stitching and Visualisation Parameters

Following segmentation, ViSPACE reconstructs a whole-slide segmentation map by stitching together the individual patch predictions. During this stage, publication-quality visualisation images and a GeoJSON representation of the segmentation are generated. The default stitching parameters are suitable for most applications. Users will rarely need to modify `STEP_X` or `STEP_Y`, as ViSPACE automatically determines the correct tile spacing from the segmentation manifest. The parameters most commonly adjusted are `MAX_PX`, `ALPHA`, and `THUMB_MAX`, which control the appearance and resolution of the generated visualisation images without affecting the underlying segmentation or spatial feature calculations.

2.5 Tumour ROI Extraction Parameters

Following whole-slide segmentation, ViSPACE identifies tumour-rich regions that are suitable for downstream spatial analysis. Rather than analysing every segmented tile, the pipeline groups neighbouring tumour-containing tiles into spatial clusters and generates non-overlapping square regions of interest (ROIs). These ROIs are used as the input for all subsequent tumour microenvironment analyses, including tumour–stroma ratio (TSR), stromal tumour-infiltrating lymphocyte (sTIL) quantification, immune proximity analysis, necrosis proximity analysis, and tumour morphology measurements. For most applications, the default ROI extraction parameters provide robust tumour localisation. Users may adjust `ROI_SIZE_UM`, `ROI_MIN_TUMOR_FRAC`, `ROI_MIN_CLUSTER_TILES`, and `ROI_MERGE_GAP_UM` when analysing datasets with markedly different tumour morphology or tissue architecture. The visualisation parameters `ROI_THUMB_WIDTH` and `ROI_COLOR_BY_CLUSTER` affect only the appearance of the generated overlay figures and have no impact on the computed spatial features.

2.6 Cluster TSR and sTILs Scoring Parameters

Following tumour ROI extraction, ViSPACE constructs non-overlapping cluster scoring polygons by buffering and merging the tumour ROI boxes. Within each scoring polygon, the segmented tissue is used to compute the tumour–stroma ratio (TSR) and stromal tumour-infiltrating lymphocyte (sTIL) score. Background pixels are excluded from all quantitative measurements, while tissue coverage is recorded as a quality-control metric.

The default configuration is suitable for most whole-slide image analyses and follows the recommended Salgado definition of stromal tumour-infiltrating lymphocytes. In routine applications, `TILS_DENOMINATOR` should remain set to `salgado`. The parameters most likely to require adjustment are `CLUSTER_BUFFER_UM`, which controls the extent of the scoring polygon around tumour regions, and `CLUSTER_MIN_ROI_BOXES`, which determines the minimum cluster size included in the analysis. The remaining parameters primarily act as quality-control filters and should generally retain their default values unless analysing datasets with substantially different tissue characteristics.

2.7 Immune Proximity Parameters

The immune proximity stage quantifies the spatial relationship between tumour-infiltrating lymphocytes (TILs) and the tumour boundary. Using the cluster scoring polygons generated in the previous stage, ViSPACE measures the distribution of inflammatory tissue relative to tumour regions and classifies each tumour cluster into biologically meaningful immune phenotypes. The default parameter values were selected to characterise immune organisation in H&E whole-slide images and generally require no modification. The proximity thresholds determine the spatial

distances reported in the output, whereas the remaining parameters define the decision boundaries used to classify tumour clusters into the *immune-desert*, *immune-penetrated*, *margin-localised*, *immune-excluded*, and *peritumoral* immune phenotypes. These values should only be adjusted when alternative biological definitions or cohort-specific criteria are required.

2.8 Necrosis Proximity Parameters

The necrosis proximity stage characterises the spatial relationship between necrotic tissue, tumour, inflammatory tissue, and stroma within each tumour cluster. In addition to quantifying the distribution of necrosis relative to the tumour boundary, the analysis measures necrosis-immune coupling and assigns a biologically interpretable necrosis phenotype to each tumour cluster. The default values were selected to provide robust characterisation of necrotic tissue organisation in H&E whole-slide images and generally require no modification. The proximity thresholds determine the spatial distance statistics reported by the pipeline, whereas the remaining parameters define the decision boundaries used to classify tumour clusters into the *necrosis-absent*, *tumour-central*, *peritumoral*, *immune-adjacent*, and *stromal-distant* necrosis phenotypes. These parameters should only be adjusted when alternative biological definitions or dataset-specific criteria are required.

2.9 Tumour Morphology Parameters

The final stage of the ViSPACE pipeline quantifies the morphological characteristics of tumour tissue within each scored tumour cluster. Following segmentation, neighbouring tumour polygons are merged into individual tumour islands, from which a range of geometric, shape, and fragmentation features are computed. Small isolated tumour fragments can optionally be excluded to reduce the influence of segmentation noise. For routine analyses, the default parameters are recommended. The minimum tumour island area of **1000 μm^2** effectively removes very small tumour fragments that would otherwise distort fragmentation and shape metrics, while preserving biologically meaningful tumour islands. Quality-control output should only be enabled when validating a new dataset or selecting an alternative island-size threshold. The tumour class names should remain unchanged unless the segmentation model produces different class labels.

Table 2.1: Complete ViSPACE configuration reference.

Group	Parameter	Default	Use	Description
Required	WSI_PATH	required	Adjustable	Path to the input WSI, such as .svs, .tif, or another OpenSlide-compatible format.
Required	CHECKPOINT	required	Adjustable	Path to the trained ViSPACE decoder checkpoint (.pt).
Required	OUT_DIR	vispace_output	Adjustable	Root directory for all intermediate and final outputs.
Tessellation	PATCH_SIZE	224	Fixed	Patch edge length in pixels. The model was trained on 224×224 patches.
Tessellation	MPP	0.25	Fixed	Microns per pixel. The released weights assume $0.25 \mu\text{m}/\text{pixel}$; this value also calibrates all area and distance features.
Tessellation	WORKERS	4	Adjustable	Number of parallel CPU workers used during Mussel tessellation.
Tessellation	SEGMENT_THRESH	20	Adjustable	Otsu-based tissue-mask threshold. Tune only for unusual staining or scanning artefacts.
Tessellation	THUMBNAIL_SIZE	(1024, 1024)	Adjustable	Tessellation thumbnail dimensions in pixels; affects quality-control previews only.
Model	VIRCHOW2_PATH	None	Optional	Local Virchow2 weights. When None , weights are fetched from Hugging Face after authentication.
Model	DEVICE	cuda	Fixed	Inference device required for the standard segmenter workflow. CUDA is expected for routine use.
Model	BATCH_SIZE	32	Adjustable	Number of patches processed per inference batch. Reduce when GPU memory is insufficient.
Model	WHITE_THRESH	220	Adjustable	Near-white background threshold used to avoid inference on blank areas.
Stitching	STEP_X	444	Optional	Informational horizontal tile spacing. <code>stitch.py</code> normally infers the real step from <code>manifest.csv</code> .
Stitching	STEP_Y	444	Optional	Informational vertical tile spacing. <code>stitch.py</code> normally infers the real step from <code>manifest.csv</code> .
Stitching	MAX_PX	4096	Adjustable	Maximum long edge of generated slide-level PNG visualisations.
Stitching	ALPHA	0.6	Adjustable	Overlay blend weight; affects visualisation only.
Stitching	THUMB_MAX	2048	Adjustable	Maximum thumbnail dimension for visualisation.
Tumour ROI	ROI_SIZE_UM	200	Adjustable	Edge length of each square tumour ROI in microns.
Tumour ROI	ROI_MIN_TUMOR_FRAC	0.20	Adjustable	Minimum tumour fraction required for a tile to enter ROI clustering.
Tumour ROI	ROI_MAX_NECROSIS	0.50	Adjustable	Maximum mean necrosis fraction allowed within a candidate ROI.
Tumour ROI	ROI_MIN_CLUSTER_TILES	3	Adjustable	Minimum connected tumour-tile count required to retain a clump.
Tumour ROI	ROI_CONNECTIVITY	8	Adjustable	Grid connectivity for clustering: 4 for edge neighbours or 8 for edge and corner neighbours.
Tumour ROI	ROI_MERGE_GAP_UM	60	Adjustable	Maximum gap in microns for merging nearby tumour clumps.
Tumour ROI	ROI_THUMB_WIDTH	1800	Optional	Width of the WSI thumbnail used for ROI overlay output.
Tumour ROI	ROI_COLOR_BY_CLUSTER	True	Optional	Colour ROI boxes by cluster identity in overlay images.
TSR/sTILs	TILS_DENOMINATOR	salgado	Adjustable	Selected sTIL denominator: <code>salgado</code> , <code>stroma_plus_inflammatory</code> , or <code>tissue</code> .
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_BUFFER_UM	300	Adjustable	Buffer around dissolved ROI boxes before cluster scoring.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MIN_ROI_BOXES	5	Adjustable	Minimum ROI-box count required to retain a cluster.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MIN_POLYGON_AREA_PX2	1.0	Optional	Minimum GeoJSON polygon area retained during scoring.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MAX_AREA_QUANTILE	1.0	Optional	Upper polygon-area quantile filter; 1.0 disables it.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MAX_AREA_MAD_Z	0.0	Optional	MAD-based polygon-area outlier threshold; 0 disables it.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MIN_TISSUE_FRACTION	0.10	Adjustable	Minimum segmented tissue fraction required for reliable cluster scores.

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Table 2.1 continued from previous page

Group	Parameter	Default	Use	Description
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MIN_TSR_DENOM_PX2	5000	Adjustable	Minimum tumour-plus-stroma denominator area for reliable TSR.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_MIN_TILS_DENOM_PX2	5000	Adjustable	Minimum selected sTIL denominator area for reliable sTILs.
TSR/sTILs	CLUSTER_NO_OVERLAY	False	Optional	Skip rendering the cluster overlay when set to True .
Immune	IMMUNE_PROXIMITY_THRESHOLDS_UM	[20, 50, 100, 200]	Adjustable	Distances used to report the percentage of TIL area near the tumour boundary.
Immune	IMMUNE_CONTACT_TOLERANCE_UM	5	Adjustable	Maximum distance counted as tumour-immune contact.
Immune	IMMUNE_DESERT_MAX_AREA_UM2	1000	Adjustable	TIL-area threshold below which a cluster is classified as immune-desert.
Immune	IMMUNE_PENETRATED_MIN_INTRA_FRAC	0.30	Adjustable	Minimum intratumoral TIL fraction for the immune-penetrated phenotype.
Immune	IMMUNE_MARGIN_MIN_PCT_50UM	50	Adjustable	Minimum TIL percentage within 50 μm for the margin-localised phenotype.
Immune	IMMUNE_EXCLUDED_MIN_MEDIAN_UM	100	Adjustable	Minimum median extratumoral distance for the immune-excluded phenotype.
Immune	IMMUNE_PERITUMORAL_MAX_MEDIAN_UM	100	Adjustable	Maximum median extratumoral distance for the peritumoral phenotype.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_PROXIMITY_THRESHOLDS_UM	[50, 100]	Adjustable	Distances used to report necrosis proximity to tumour.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_CONTACT_TOLERANCE_UM	5	Adjustable	Maximum distance counted as tumour-necrosis contact.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_IMMUNE_COUPLING_THRESHOLD_UM	20	Adjustable	Maximum necrosis-to-immune distance counted as coupled.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_MIN_COMPONENT_AREA_UM2	500	Adjustable	Minimum necrotic component area retained for analysis.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_ABSENT_MAX_AREA_UM2	500	Adjustable	Area threshold below which a cluster is classified as necrosis-absent.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_CENTRAL_MIN_INTRA_FRAC	0.50	Adjustable	Minimum intratumoral necrosis fraction for the tumour-central phenotype.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_PERITUMORAL_MIN_PCT_100UM	60	Adjustable	Minimum necrosis percentage within 100 μm for the peritumoural phenotype.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_IMMUNE_ADJACENT_MIN_COUPLING	0.20	Adjustable	Minimum immune-coupling index for the immune-adjacent phenotype.
Necrosis	NECROSIS_DISTANT_MIN_MEDIAN_UM	150	Adjustable	Median-distance threshold associated with stromal-distant necrosis.
Morphology	MORPHOLOGY_MIN_ISLAND_AREA_UM2	1000	Adjustable	Minimum tumour-island area used for shape and fragmentation metrics. Report this threshold with published morphology results.
Morphology	MORPHOLOGY_SAVE_ISLAND_QC	False	Optional	Write <code>tumor_island_qc.csv</code> with per-island measurements.
Morphology	MORPHOLOGY_TUMOR_CLASS_NAMES	tumour aliases	Optional	Accepted labels: Tumour, Tumor, tumour, and tumor.

2.10 Create a Reusable Configuration

The recommended workflow is to create one JSON configuration and reuse it for the environment check, pipeline runner, individual stages, and report generator.

```
python config.py \  
  --wsi-path slides/example.svs \  
  --checkpoint TNBC_weights/TNBC_best.pt \  
  --out-dir vispace_output \  
  --device cuda \  
  --batch-size 32 \  
  --print-config > run_config.json
```

Inspect the saved configuration before starting a long run:

```
python environment_check.py --from-json run_config.json
```

Chapter 3

Running the ViSPACE Pipeline

The full pipeline is orchestrated by `run_vispace.py`. It executes stages in dependency order, skips stages whose sentinel outputs already exist, stops on the first failure, and can rerun selected stages when requested.

3.1 Complete Run

```
python run_vispace.py --from-json run_config.json
```

From Python:

```
from config import PipelineConfig
from run_vispace import run_vispace

cfg = PipelineConfig(
    WSI_PATH="slides/example.svs",
    CHECKPOINT="TNBC_weights/TNBC_best.pt",
    OUT_DIR="vispace_output",
)

results = run_vispace(cfg.WSI_PATH, cfg)
print(results["success"])
print(results["total_elapsed_s"])
```

3.2 Pipeline Command Reference

Table 3.1 is the single execution reference for the pipeline. Commands assume that `run_config.json` has already been created.

Table 3.1: ViSPACE pipeline stages and commands.

Stage	Script or action	Purpose	Command
–	<code>environment_check.py</code>	Validate dependencies, CUDA, package versions, paths, authentication, and permissions.	<code>python environment_check.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
1	<code>tessellate.py</code>	Tile tissue regions with Mussel.	<code>python tessellate.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
2	<code>segmenter.py</code>	Run Virchow2 and the pixel-wise decoder.	<code>python segmenter.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
3	<code>stitch.py</code>	Stitch tile predictions and generate whole-slide GeoJSON.	<code>python stitch.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
4	<code>tumor_roi_overlay.py</code>	Identify tumour-rich tiles, form clusters, and generate ROI boxes.	<code>python tumor_roi_overlay.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
5	<code>cluster_tils_tsr_scoring.py</code>	Build scoring polygons and compute cluster and WSI TSR/sTILs.	<code>python cluster_tils_tsr_scoring.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
6	<code>immune_proximity_features.py</code>	Quantify TIL position relative to tumour boundaries.	<code>python immune_proximity_features.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
7	<code>necrosis_proximity_features.py</code>	Quantify necrosis position and tissue-context coupling.	<code>python necrosis_proximity_features.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
8	<code>tumor_morphology_features.py</code>	Compute tumour area, shape, island, spread, and fragmentation features.	<code>python tumor_morphology_features.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
All	<code>run_vispace.py</code>	Execute all analytical stages in order and resume from completed outputs.	<code>python run_vispace.py --from-json run_config.json</code>
Subset	<code>run_vispace.py--stages</code>	Run selected stages after their prerequisites already exist.	<code>python run_vispace.py --from-json run_config.json --stages cluster_tils_tsr_score, immune_proximity, necrosis_proximity</code>
Force	<code>run_vispace.py--force-stages</code>	Rerun specified stages even when sentinel outputs exist.	<code>python run_vispace.py --from-json run_config.json --force-stages tumor_roi_overlay</code>
Report	<code>report/generate_report.py</code>	Generate and optionally render a slide-specific Quarto report.	<code>python report/generate_report.py --from-json run_config.json --render --to html</code>

3.3 Processing Multiple Slides

ViSPACE processes one slide per call. Use a base configuration and replace only `WSI_PATH` for each slide:

```
from pathlib import Path
from dataclasses import replace
from config import PipelineConfig
from run_vispace import run_vispace

base_cfg = PipelineConfig(
    CHECKPOINT="TNBC_weights/TNBC_best.pt",
    OUT_DIR="vispace_output",
)

for slide in Path("slides").glob("*.svs"):
    cfg = replace(base_cfg, WSI_PATH=str(slide))
    result = run_vispace(str(slide), cfg)
    if not result["success"]:
        print(f"Failed: {slide}")
```

3.4 Jupyter Notebook Use

Every stage exposes a Python function of the form `run_*(wsi_path, cfg)`. A notebook can keep one configuration object in memory and call stages directly. After editing a module during an interactive session, reload it with `importlib.reload` before rerunning the stage.

Chapter 4

Output Directory Structure

ViSPACE creates one directory per slide under `OUT_DIR`. The slide name is derived from the WSI filename stem.

```
vispace_output/  
'-- <slide_name>/  
  |-- tessellation/  
  |   |-- patches/  
  |   |-- <slide>.h5  
  |   |-- mask.png  
  |   |-- grid_mask.png  
  |   '-- thumbnail.png  
  |-- segmentation/  
  |   |-- manifest.csv  
  |   |-- segmentation_all_classes.geojson  
  |   '-- <slide>_segmentation.png  
  |-- spatial_feature_results/  
  |   |-- tumor_roi_overlay/  
  |   |-- cluster_tils_tsr_score/  
  |   |-- immune_proximity/  
  |   |-- necrosis_proximity/  
  |   '-- tumor_morphology/  
  |-- <slide>_vispace_report.qmd
```

4.1 Output Files

Table 4.1: Principal ViSPACE output files.

Directory	File	Purpose
tessellation	patches/	Extracted 224×224 patch PNGs.
tessellation	<slide>.h5	Mussel tile manifest and tessellation meta-data.
tessellation	mask.png, grid_mask.png, thumbnail.png	Tissue mask, accepted grid, and tessellation thumbnail.
segmentation	manifest.csv	Per-tile coordinates and predicted class fractions.
segmentation	segmentation_all_classes.geojson	Whole-slide tissue polygons used by spatial stages.
segmentation	<slide>_segmentation.png	Colour segmentation quality-control image.

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Directory	File	Purpose
tumor_roi_ overlay	tumor_roi_boxes.csv	ROI coordinates and composition; primary input to cluster scoring.
tumor_roi_ overlay	tumor_roi_boxes_pseudo_ thumbnail.png	ROI overlay on the segmentation-derived pseudo-thumbnail.
tumor_roi_ overlay	tumor_roi_boxes_wsi_ thumbnail.png	Optional ROI overlay on the source WSI thumbnail.
cluster_tils_ tsr_score	cluster_scoring_polygons. geojson	Final non-overlapping cluster scoring polygons.
cluster_tils_ tsr_score	tils_tsr_by_cluster.csv	Cluster-level TSR, sTILs, tissue areas, and reliability fields.
cluster_tils_ tsr_score	tils_tsr_wsi_summary.csv	Area-weighted whole-slide TSR and sTIL summary.
cluster_tils_ tsr_score	cluster_tils_tsr_overlay. png	Tissue map and cluster-score visualisation.
immune_ proximity	immune_proximity_by_ cluster.csv	Cluster-level TIL proximity and immune phenotype features.
immune_ proximity	immune_proximity_wsi_ summary.csv	Whole-slide immune proximity summary.
immune_ proximity	immune_proximity_plot.png	Immune distance, proximity-zone, and phenotype visualisation.
necrosis_ proximity	necrosis_proximity_by_ cluster.csv	Cluster-level necrosis proximity and phenotype features.
necrosis_ proximity	necrosis_proximity_wsi_ summary.csv	Whole-slide necrosis proximity summary.
necrosis_ proximity	necrosis_distance_figure. png	Necrosis distance and proximity-zone visualisation.
necrosis_ proximity	necrosis_tissue_context_ figure.png	Necrosis-immune coupling and phenotype visualisation.
tumor_ morphology	tumor_core_features_by_ cluster.csv	Cluster-level tumour area, shape, island, spread, and fragmentation features.
tumor_ morphology	tumor_core_wsi_summary. csv	Whole-slide morphology summary.
tumor_ morphology	tumor_island_qc.csv	Optional per-island quality-control measurements.
report	<slide>_vispace_report. qmd	Slide-specific Quarto source.
report	<slide>_vispace_report. html	Rendered HTML report when Quarto rendering is enabled.

Chapter 5

Report Generation

Report generation is the final, optional post-processing step in the ViSPACE workflow. It should be performed only after all analytical stages have completed and their outputs have been written to the slide-specific output directory.

The report generator does not rerun tessellation, segmentation, stitching, or spatial feature extraction. Instead, it reads the completed ViSPACE outputs, inserts the current whole-slide image path and output directory into a Quarto template, and writes a slide-specific Quarto Markdown (.qmd) file.

The generated .qmd file must subsequently be rendered using the Quarto command-line interface.

5.1 Generating the QMD File in JupyterLab

Within a JupyterLab notebook, generate the slide-specific report source using the existing ViSPACE configuration object:

```
from generate_qmd_file import generate_report

report_qmd = generate_report(
    wsi_path=cfg.WSI_PATH,
    cfg=cfg,
)

print(f"Generated report file: {report_qmd}")
```

5.2 Rendering the Report with Quarto

After generating the .qmd file, render it from the Linux terminal using:

```
quarto render vispace_report_slide.qmd
```

The `quarto render` command creates the final document using the output format declared in the Quarto YAML front matter. The target .qmd file must be supplied as the first command-line argument.